

While Google Cast used to require both the sender and receiver to be on the same WiFi network, a 'Guest Mode' was later introduced. You can now find Chromecast built in receivers locally and connect to them directly. Very handy for when you want to safeguard your FUP and don't particularly want to give guests access to your WiFi. Game developers are also working on methods to use Google Cast to make your phone a second screen wireless controller (Think Nintendo WiiU). The possibilities are vast! Ever since Google made the SDK public on February 3rd, 2014, more than 40,000 Chromecast ready apps are now on the Play Store, with many versatile uses.

Google Cast is far superior to regular old Bluetooth streaming for a lot of reasons, including being able to take calls during the stream, not having to be reasonably close to the speaker to ensure a stable Bluetooth connection and playing the same music across multiple speakers.

A short interlude about the Nexus Player

A fact not very well known is that the Nexus line of products actually had media players in it too. First was the Nexus Q. It was unveiled at the Google I/O in 2012 as a way for you to view your other Play Store services on an HDTV, such as Play Music and Play Movies. It was priced at \$299 (₹19,000 approx)... and it never took off. The community backlash over the huge price tag and the severe lack of features made Google shelve the product. The Chromecast is treated as the spiritual successor to the Nexus Q.

Google tried its hand at a Nexus media player once again in 2014 with the Nexus Player in collaboration with Asus. It was basically an upgraded Chromecast that came with a Bluetooth remote and you could do stuff like emulate games on it, among other things – stuff you can't do with a Chromecast. It was also priced reasonably at \$99 (₹6,300 approx) but unfortunately, did not receive much attention or sales.



Nexus Player

The other part of the equation - The Chromecast!

Google currently has three Chromecasts in its line up. While they all follow the same general principle of turning the device they are connected to into a Chromecast Built In device, they all have different specific uses.